Gradient Pulse — Special Edition, October 12

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The launch

• Meta Superintelligence Labs shipped Muse Wonder and Muse Wonder Full on Oct 12 — Meta's first frontier models, 'our most capable models to date'

• Wonder: $4/$20 per 1M tokens via Meta Model API, ~1M context; Wonder Full: no API at all, Muse Code subscribers only ($50/$200)

• Headline features: Active Memory (carries context across conversations) and Active Focus (persists through hard multi-step tasks)

• Break with the Llama era: Wonder is closed — no weights released, no date promised

The numbers

• Independent Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index: Wonder Full 56 (#2 worldwide), Wonder 52; Opus 5.5 leads at 58; Fable 5.1 / GPT-6 Astra / Gemini 4 Argon at 53

• Wonder Full is +8 over Muse Spark 1.3 (48) in one generation; scores are at max reasoning settings, index uncertainty ~±1%

• Meta's own announcement carries no benchmark scores; its head-to-head win charts (SWE-Marathon, MemoryBench) are Meta-run and unverified

• Retention is the business test: Sensor Tower estimates 73% day-1 Muse retention (nearly 2x ChatGPT) but ChatGPT ahead by day 9; downloads slowing (Hunterbrook, Oct 9)

Arena flip

• Agent Arena rematch: OpenAI Dots vs Meta Muse (revision of the Oct 3 bout) — verdict FLIPS from OpenAI to Meta

• Decisive round: Under the Hood flips to Meta on the Wonder engine evidence; Pricing & access stays Meta, Enterprise fit stays OpenAI, three rounds drawn

• Use-case scorecard now 3-2 Meta; full round-by-round evidence is in the Situation Room premium Arena

Hype Check

• Claim: Zuckerberg — Muse Wonder 'brings us to the frontier'

• Independent index backs it: #2 worldwide, ahead of three rival flagships — verdict CONFIRMED

• Asterisks: Opus 5.5 still #1 and Meta's win charts are vendor-run; Wonder Full is subscription-gated with no API

Hype Check

Claim: Mark Zuckerberg's claim that Muse Wonder "brings us to the frontier" — Meta back at the frontier of AI models.

Verdict: confirmed

Checked against the one scoreboard Meta doesn't control: the independent Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index puts Wonder Full at 56, #2 worldwide behind Claude Opus 5.5 (58) and ahead of Fable 5.1, GPT-6 Astra and Gemini 4 Argon (53) — an 8-point jump over Muse Spark 1.3 (48). The claim holds. Two asterisks: frontier is not first (Meta's charts claiming outright wins over Opus are Meta-run and unverified; the index gap is ~2 points at max reasoning settings, ±1% uncertainty), and Wonder Full is gated — no API at any price, Muse Code subscribers only, so developers can't build on the flagship. Verdict: confirmed — confirmed claim, gated product.